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Hiring Team
Pinterest

Dear Pinterest Hiring Team,

I am a Ph.D. student in Computer Science at the University of Central Florida, expecting to graduate in Spring 2029, and I am applying for the PhD Machine Learning Internship for 2027. My research focuses on social reasoning and Theory of Mind. I am interested in how AI systems use language and context to understand people, and how this research can inform user modeling and more relevant experiences.

As the lead author of OmniToM, accepted to the NeurIPS 2026 Evaluations & Datasets Track, I led research on social reasoning in language models. I developed a benchmark, coordinated human review, and evaluated a range of models. This work strengthened my experience in research design, dataset development, quality control, and analyzing model behavior. It also taught me how to organize a collaborative research effort around a clear question and communicate its results.

My other projects have given me complementary experience with data and implementation. In BIAS-101, I curated and analyzed video data to study demographic representation in recognition systems. In DETECT, I led a student team that built and evaluated a real-time system. Together, these projects gave me practice with research data, team-based implementation, and system evaluation.

Pinterest's combination of independent research and applied machine learning appeals to me. I would welcome the opportunity to bring my experience in social reasoning research, Python programming, dataset development, and model evaluation to projects related to language understanding, user modeling, and personalized experiences.

Sincerely,

Adam Bawatneh